

25/09/2025

Scrawny, Peril, Gleam, Ferocious, Yearn

## 1. Scrawny (दुबला-पतला / कमजोर) (Adjective) (Scraw-nee) (Negative Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Unattractively thin or weak in appearance.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** दुबला-पतला, कमजोर या कमजोर शरीर वाला।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
  - Middle English *scrawny* (thin, meager) → **Possibly from Old Norse *skrā* (shrivel) → Proto-Germanic root.**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
  - **Synonyms:** skinny, bony, gaunt
  - **Antonyms:** strong, healthy, sturdy
- **Connotation:** Negative (often critical, implying weakness).
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A *scrawny* cat searching for food in an alley.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In literature, the word *scrawny* is often used to highlight fragility or neglect. A *scrawny* soldier in historical accounts may represent the toll of famine or war. Similarly, in health discussions, children who appear *scrawny* may be suffering from malnutrition. The word

is not neutral—it conveys an image of unhealthy thinness, unlike words like “slim” or “lean,” which may carry positive undertones. When scientists report on body mass index, they often avoid subjective terms like *scrawny* and instead use clinical terminology. However, in everyday speech, it remains a descriptive way to show visible frailty.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** The boy looked *scrawny* after the long illness. (लंबी बीमारी के बाद लड़का दुबला-पतला लग रहा था।)
-  **Incorrect:** The boy looked *scrawnyly*. (लड़का दुबले-पतले ढंग से लग रहा था।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Identify “scrawny” areas in your life—weak, undernourished, or underdeveloped habits that drain energy instead of building strength. Just as a scrawny body needs nourishment, your routines need enrichment. Replace thin, ineffective efforts with solid, healthy practices. Strengthen your core disciplines, and watch your productivity and resilience grow sturdier.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- The *scrawny* tree bent in the storm. (दुबला-पतला पेड़ तूफान में झुक गया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
  - S (Subject): The scrawny tree
  - V (Verb – Intransitive): bent
  - O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive)
  - (Adverbial Phrase of Cause/Condition): in the storm
  - ↳ Cause/Condition: in the storm

- **Common Collocations:**

- scrawny boy, scrawny arms, scrawny tree, scrawny figure.

- **My Statement:**

- The scrawny girl was advised to eat proper meals and go to the gym three times a week.
- He seemed malnourished when I looked at his scrawny arms.
- The scrawny tree broke within minutes of the windstorm.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

## 2. Peril (संकट / खतरा) (Noun/Verb) (Pe-ril) (Serious/Dangerous Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Serious and immediate danger; risk of harm.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** गंभीर खतरा या जोखिम।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
  - Latin *periculum* (trial, danger) → **Old French *peril*** → Middle English *peril*.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
  - **Synonyms:** danger, hazard, risk, threat
  - **Antonyms:** safety, security, protection
- **Connotation:** Strong negative (life-threatening or harmful).
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A climber facing *peril* on a steep mountain.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Throughout history, explorers have braved great *peril* to expand human knowledge. From navigating unknown seas to climbing treacherous mountains, *peril* has always been part of progress. In modern society, climate change poses *peril* to ecosystems and human life. Journalists often use the word to emphasize the seriousness of threats. Unlike general “risk,” *peril* conveys urgency and severity. For insurance, “perils” describe specific causes of damage such as fire, theft, or natural disasters. The word underlines

that while danger may sometimes be avoidable, *peril* often demands immediate action and highlights vulnerability.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** The hikers were in *peril* when the storm struck. (तूफान आने पर पर्वतारोही संकट में थे।)
-  **Incorrect:** The hikers were *periling*. (गलत प्रयोग।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Recognize the perils in your daily choices—risky habits, distractions, or shortcuts that endanger your growth. Much like travelers avoid dangerous paths, you must avoid harmful routines. Replace perilous actions with safe, strategic ones. Facing perils with awareness and preparation transforms threats into opportunities for strength and wisdom.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- The soldiers marched into great *peril*. (सैनिक बड़े संकट में आगे बढ़े।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
  - S (Subject): The soldiers
  - V (Verb – Transitive): marched
  - O (Object): into great peril
  - (Adverbial Clause of Time/Manner): — (None; not specified)
  - ↳ Object: great peril

- **Common Collocations:**

- mortal peril, face peril, at your peril, perilous journey.

- **My Statement:**

- **(NOUN)**
  - We have to face the perils of life bravely.
  - Look at the perils carefully and devise a strategic plan.
  - The journey was filled with perils, but you had to step carefully to avoid them.
- **(VERB)**
  - Your plan imperiled the whole crew.
  - Any wrong move can imperil our whole plan.

- Without proper planning, we can imperil ourselves as well as others.

- **My Notes:**

- Peril is mostly a noun; to make it a verb, use “imperil” (to put in danger).  
Example: “Pollution imperils marine life.”

### 3. Gleam (चमक / झलक) (Noun/Verb) (Gleem) (Positive/Neutral Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** A soft, shining light or a faint sign of something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** हल्की चमक या झलक।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
  - Old English *glēam* (brightness, joy) → **Proto-Germanic *glaimiz* (shining).**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
  - **Synonyms:** shine, sparkle, flash, glimmer
  - **Antonyms:** dullness, darkness, gloom
- **Connotation:** Positive, often hopeful or attractive.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A *gleam* of sunlight through the window at dawn.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In literature and speeches, the word *gleam* often symbolizes hope. A *gleam* in someone's eye suggests determination or joy. Photographers capture the *gleam* of light to create striking images. In scientific writing, a *gleam* of data may hint at a new discovery. Unlike strong light, *gleam* implies subtle brightness. It also carries a metaphorical sense, representing possibilities or emotions shining faintly beneath the surface. For instance, a *gleam* of compassion in times of conflict can be transformative. Thus, the word combines physical brightness with symbolic meaning across contexts.



- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** A *gleam* of hope appeared in her eyes. (उसकी आँखों में आशा की झलक आई।)
-  **Incorrect:** She was *gleamingly*. (गलत प्रयोग।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Notice the small gleams in your life—tiny sparks of progress, hope, or creativity. Just as a gleam of light brightens darkness, these moments can illuminate your path forward. Capture and nurture them instead of ignoring them. Over time, consistent gleams accumulate into a radiant glow of achievement.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- The sword *gleamed* under the torchlight. (तलवार मशाल की रोशनी में चमकी।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
  - S (Subject): The sword
  - V (Verb – Intransitive): gleamed
  - O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive)
  - (Adverbial Phrase of Place/Setting): under the torchlight
  - ↳ Place/Setting: under the torchlight

- **Common Collocations:**

- gleam of hope, gleam in the eyes, metallic gleam, gleam of sunlight.

- **My Statement:**

- **(NOUN)**

- I felt a gleam of hope after waking early in the morning.
- The gleam in her eyes showed confidence in his words.
- The gleam of sunlight was bright in the middle of the day.

- **(VERB)**

- The surface gleamed in the scorching sun.
- The water on the leaves gleamed brightly.
- His face gleamed with freshness after applying moisturizer and sunscreen.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

#### 4. Ferocious (उग्र / भयंकर) (Adjective) (Fe-ro-shus) (Aggressive Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Savagely fierce, violent, or intense.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** उग्र, भयंकर, हिंसक।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
  - Latin *ferox* (wild, bold) → **ferocious** (through Old French and Middle English).
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
  - **Synonyms:** savage, brutal, fierce
  - **Antonyms:** gentle, mild, calm
- **Connotation:** Strong negative (danger, aggression).
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A *ferocious* tiger attacking its prey.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

The natural world is full of *ferocious* predators like lions and sharks, whose survival depends on aggression. In human history, wars have often been described as *ferocious* battles, emphasizing brutality and intensity. The term is also used metaphorically—such as a *ferocious* debate in politics, or a *ferocious* appetite for learning. Unlike mild descriptors, *ferocious* highlights uncontrolled power or passion. In journalism, using the word dramatizes events, capturing readers' attention. It suggests a force so intense that it overwhelms balance, whether physical, emotional, or intellectual.



- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** The lion is a *ferocious* animal. (शेर एक भयंकर जानवर है।)
-  **Incorrect:** The lion is a *ferociously*. (गलत प्रयोग।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Approach challenges with ferocious focus—intense, determined, and uncompromising. Just as a ferocious storm leaves no room for weakness, channel energy and persistence into tasks that matter most. Avoid half-hearted efforts; intensity magnifies results. Being ferocious doesn't mean reckless—it means purposeful, disciplined aggression toward achieving your goals.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- The boxer fought with *ferocious* determination. (मुक्केबाज़ ने भयंकर दृढ़ संकल्प के साथ लड़ाई की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
  - S (Subject): The boxer
  - V (Verb – Transitive): fought
  - O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive in this context, though intensity is expressed through adverbial phrase)
  - (Adverbial Phrase of Manner): with ferocious determination
    - ↳ Manner: ferocious determination

- **Common Collocations:**

- ferocious animal, ferocious storm, ferocious attack, ferocious debate.

- **My Statement:**

- The manager implemented ferocious working hours to ensure everyone gave their 100% effort.
- It was a ferocious attack on soldiers at night.
- A ferocious debate erupted in the news after election fraud was disclosed by the opposing party.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

## 5. Yearn (तरसना / लालसा करना) (Verb) (Yurn) (Emotional Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To have an intense longing or desire for something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** गहरी इच्छा या तरस।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
  - Old English *giernan* (to desire) → Proto-Germanic *girnōnā* → Proto-Indo-European *gher-* (to like, want).
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
  - **Synonyms:** long for, crave, desire, pine
  - **Antonyms:** dislike, reject, despise
- **Connotation:** Strongly emotional, often positive but sometimes painful.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A migrant worker who *yearns* to see his family again.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Human history is shaped by what people *yearn* for—freedom, love, knowledge, or prosperity. Writers use the word to capture deep emotional longing. Unlike ordinary desire, to *yearn* implies intensity, persistence, and often sadness. A scientist may *yearn* to solve a mystery, while a soldier may *yearn* for peace at home. The word reflects the human condition—our unfulfilled wishes that keep driving progress. It can also describe

spiritual quests, as people *yearn* for meaning beyond material life. Thus, *yearn* is both emotional and motivational, expressing the ache of longing and the power of aspiration.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** She *yearns* for freedom. (वह स्वतंत्रता के लिए तरसती है।)
-  **Incorrect:** She *yearns freedom*. (वह स्वतंत्रता तरसती है।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Acknowledge what you truly yearn for—goals, growth, or meaningful experiences. Yearning signals what your heart and mind prioritize. Instead of letting longing turn into frustration, channel it into action. Transform desire into discipline, hope into effort, and dreams into achievable steps. What you yearn for most deserves your focused pursuit.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- They *yearned* for a better life. (वे एक बेहतर जीवन के लिए तरस रहे थे।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
  - S (Subject): They
  - V (Verb – Transitive): yearned
  - O (Object): for a better life

- **Common Collocations:**

- yearn for freedom, yearn for love, yearn for success, yearn to return.

- **My Statement:**

- The prisoners of war yearn for freedom.
- The adult yearns for true love.
- A struggling student yearns to get good grades and to find ways to maintain them.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]